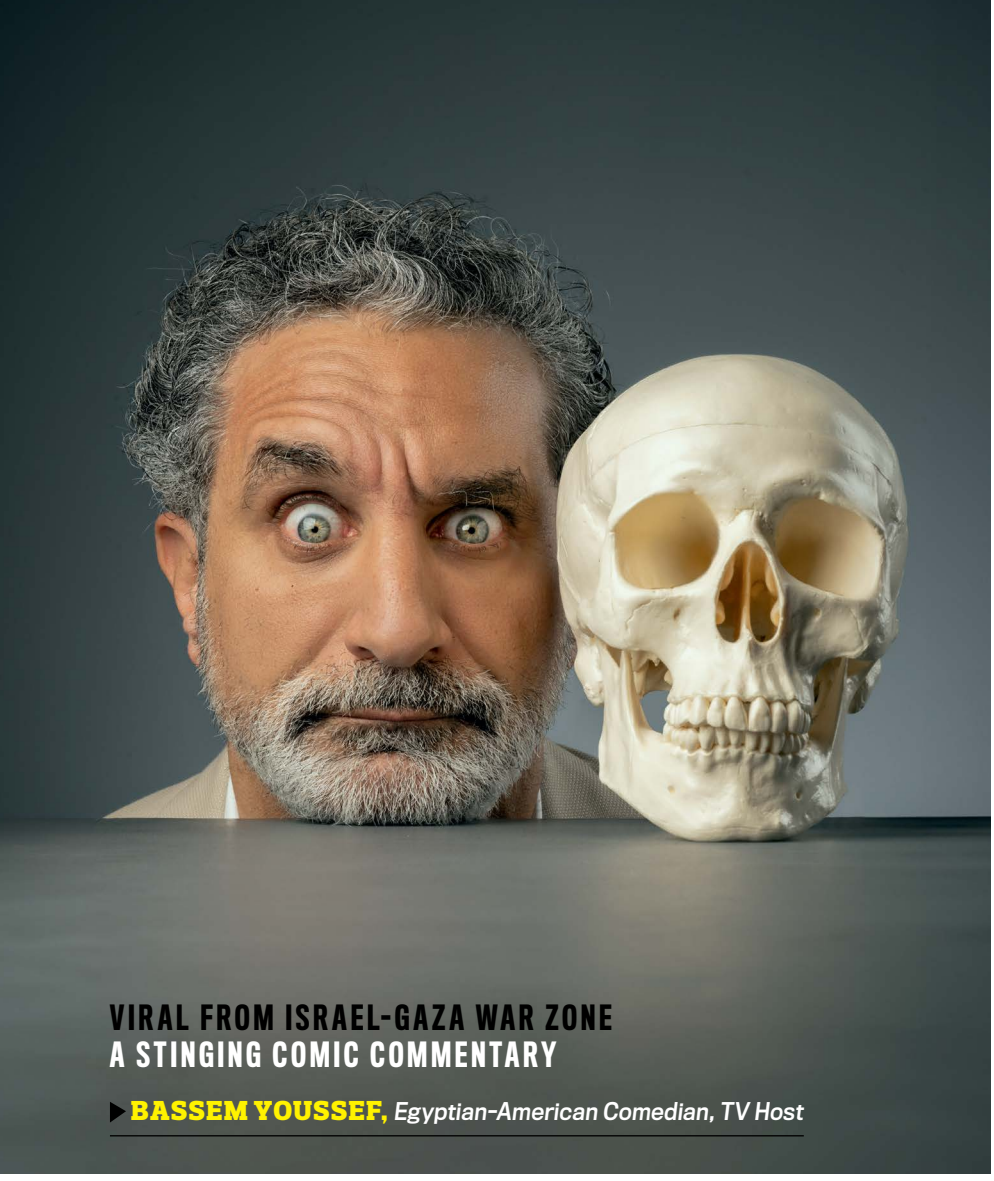


VIRAL FROM ISRAEL-GAZA WAR ZONE
A STINGING COMIC COMMENTARY

▶ **BASSEM YOUSSEF,** *Egyptian-American Comedian, TV Host*



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Youssef detailed how dark humour makes for uncomfortable viewing and listening. "Those who manipulate and blackmail people through lies and fear know that satire is their kryptonite"
- When asked what gives him hope in such dark times, the humorist singled out the youth who don't subscribe to "the legacy media" but use social media platforms like TikTok to acquire information and know the truth

THE POWER OF HUMOUR

In October 2023, Bassem Youssef became a viral sensation when he appeared on the 'Piers Morgan Uncensored' show and dropped many truth bombs during the course of the interview. It wasn't lost on him how unnerved people were with his satirical commentary on the Israel-Hamas war. Even as it allegedly lost him work in Hollywood, it also added to his fan base and came with sold-out shows in Europe. "I was put in a position to defend people who were vilified while being slaughtered because the Israeli propaganda made millions believe that these people deserve to die. They did it through propaganda, twisting facts and emotional blackmail," Bassem said while speaking at the India Today Conclave. "In these situations, the truth doesn't work. Facts don't work. You need to destroy propaganda in a way that is slick and effective. Suddenly, satire comes in handy." ■

KILLING HUMANS IS DIFFICULT BUT DOING IT BECAUSE OF FEELING SUPERIOR OR ENTITLED, THAT'S EASY. IN SHORT, HUMANS HAVE BEEN CONSISTENT ABOUT ONE THING AND ONE THING ALONE, BEING A****S TO OTHER HUMANS**

I'm sure that a lot of people who've been called self-loathing Indians are people who criticise what's happening in India out of love. If I don't care about my country, I will not criticise what's happening, right? Or if I'm complicit in what's happening, why would I criticise?

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**